

# Lecture 2

## Linear Regression

# Outline

## ■ Linear Regression

- Simple Example
- Model

## ■ Learning

- Closed Form
- Gradient Descent
- SGD

## ■ Advanced Topics

- Probabilistic Interpretation of LMS
- L2 Regularization
- L1 Regularization

# Linear Regression

给定数据集

- Given a data set  $D = \{(\mathbf{x}_1, y_1), (\mathbf{x}_2, y_2), \dots, (\mathbf{x}_m, y_m)\}$   
where  $\mathbf{x}_i = (x_{i1}; x_{i2}; \dots; x_{id})$   $y_i \in \mathbb{R}$
- The aim of linear regression 模型目标
  - Learn a **linear model** that can accurately predict the real-valued output labels
- For discrete variables (categorical features)
  - An ordinal relationship exists between values 映射
    - Convert the variables into numerical variables (map each rank to an integer)
  - No ordinal relationship exists one-hot 编码
    - Convert the discrete variable with  $k$  possible values into a  $k$ -dimensional vector (one-hot encoding)

# Linear Regression

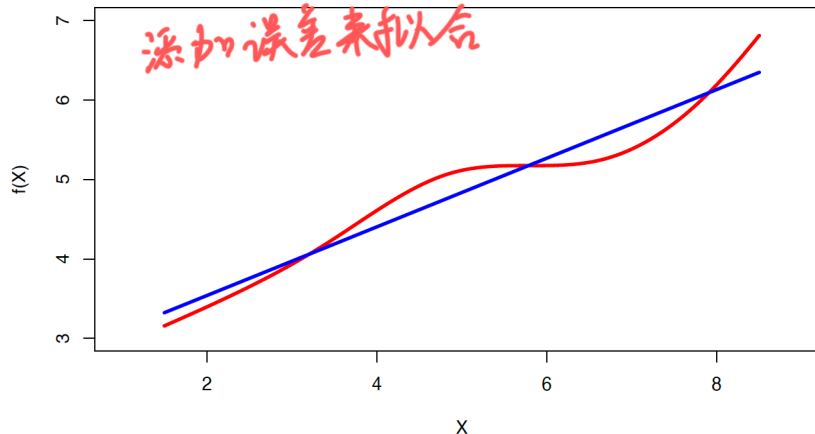
- Linear regression aims to learn the function:

$$f(x) = wx + b, \text{ such that } f(x_i) \simeq y_i, i = 1, \dots, m$$

- True regression functions are never linear!

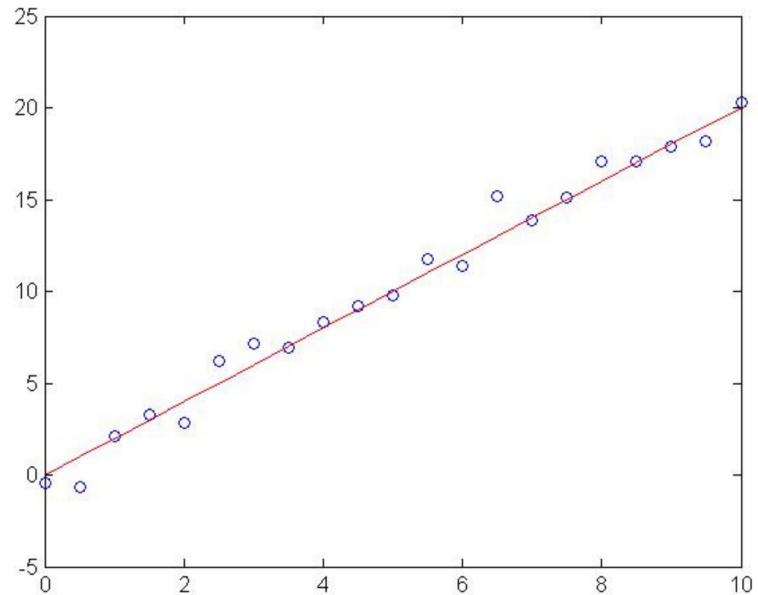
$$y = wx + b + \epsilon$$

where  $\epsilon$  is an error term of measurement error or other noise



# Linear Regression example

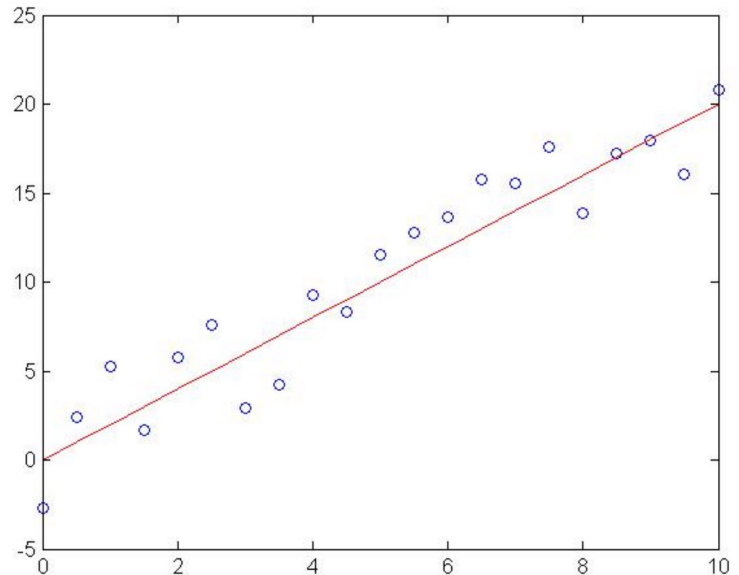
- Generated:  $w=2$
- Recovered:  $w=2.03$
- Noise:  $\text{std}=1$



Slide courtesy of William Cohen

# Linear Regression example

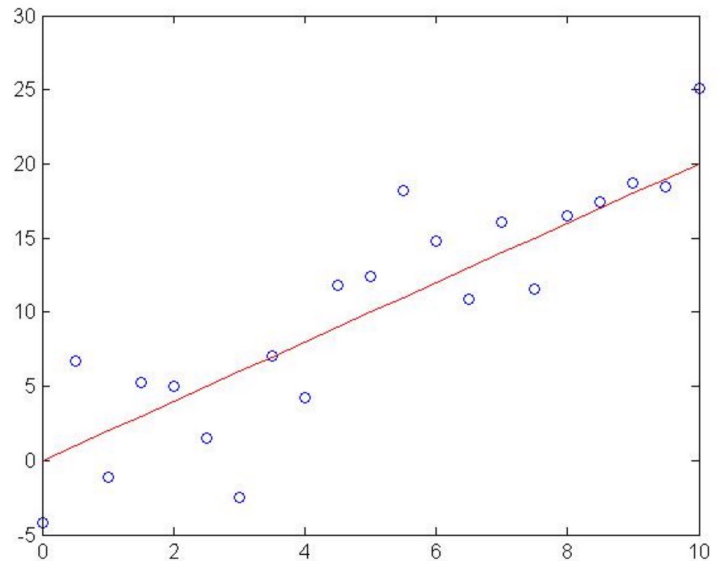
- Generated:  $w=2$
- Recovered:  $w=2.05$
- Noise:  $\text{std}=2$



Slide courtesy of William Cohen

# Linear Regression example

- Generated:  $w=2$
- Recovered:  $w=2.08$
- Noise:  $\text{std}=4$



Slide courtesy of William Cohen

# Linear Regression

**Data:** Inputs are continuous vectors of length  $d$ . Outputs are continuous scalars.

$$\mathcal{D} = \left\{ \mathbf{x}^{(i)}, y^{(i)} \right\}_{i=1}^m \text{ where } \mathbf{x} \in \mathbb{R}^d \text{ and } y \in \mathbb{R}$$

**Prediction:** Output is a linear function of the inputs.

$$\hat{y} = f_{\theta}(\mathbf{x}) = \theta_1 x_1 + \theta_2 x_2 + \cdots + \theta_d x_d$$

$$\hat{y} = f_{\theta}(\mathbf{x}) = \boldsymbol{\theta}^T \mathbf{x} \quad (\text{We assume } x_1 \text{ is } 1)$$

**Learning:** finds the parameters that minimize some objective function. 模型目标:

$$\boldsymbol{\theta}^* = \arg \min_{\boldsymbol{\theta}} J(\boldsymbol{\theta})$$



# Least Squares

- Our goal is to learn a linear function:

$$f(x) = wx + b, \text{ such that } f(x_i) \simeq y_i, i = 1, \dots, m$$

- We minimize the sum of the squares:

$$\begin{aligned} J(\theta) &\Rightarrow (w^*, b^*) = \arg \min_{(w,b)} \sum_{i=1}^m (f(x_i) - y_i)^2 \\ \theta = \begin{bmatrix} w \\ b \end{bmatrix} &= \arg \min_{(w,b)} \sum_{i=1}^m (y_i - wx_i - b)^2 \end{aligned}$$

Reduces distance between true measurements and predicted hyperplane (line in 1D)

# Least Squares

**Learning:** Three approaches to solving  $\theta^* = \arg \min_{\theta} J(\theta)$

- ❑ **Approach 1:** Closed Form  
(set derivatives equal to zero and solve for parameters)
- ❑ **Approach 2:** Gradient Descent  
(take larger – more certain – steps opposite the gradient)
- ❑ **Approach 3:** Stochastic Gradient Descent (SGD)  
(take many small steps opposite the gradient)

# Linear Regression – loss function

最小均方误差

- Minimize mean-squared error (MSE):

Loss function: How much  $\hat{y}$  differs from the true  $y$

$$E_{(w,b)} = \sum_{i=1}^m (y_i - wx_i - b)^2$$

- Calculate the derivatives of  $E_{(w,b)}$  with respect to  $w$  and  $b$ : 求导获得最优解

$$\frac{\partial E_{(w,b)}}{\partial w} = 2 \left( w \sum_{i=1}^m x_i^2 - \sum_{i=1}^m (y_i - b)x_i \right)$$

$$\frac{\partial E_{(w,b)}}{\partial b} = 2 \left( mb - \sum_{i=1}^m (y_i - wx_i) \right)$$

# Linear Regression - Least Square Method

- We have the closed-form solutions

闭式解：

$$w = \frac{\sum_{i=1}^m y_i (x_i - \bar{x})}{\sum_{i=1}^m x_i^2 - \frac{1}{m} \left( \sum_{i=1}^m x_i \right)^2}$$

$$b = \frac{1}{m} \sum_{i=1}^m (y_i - wx_i)$$

where  $\bar{x} = \frac{1}{m} \sum_{i=1}^m x_i$

# Multivariate Linear Regression

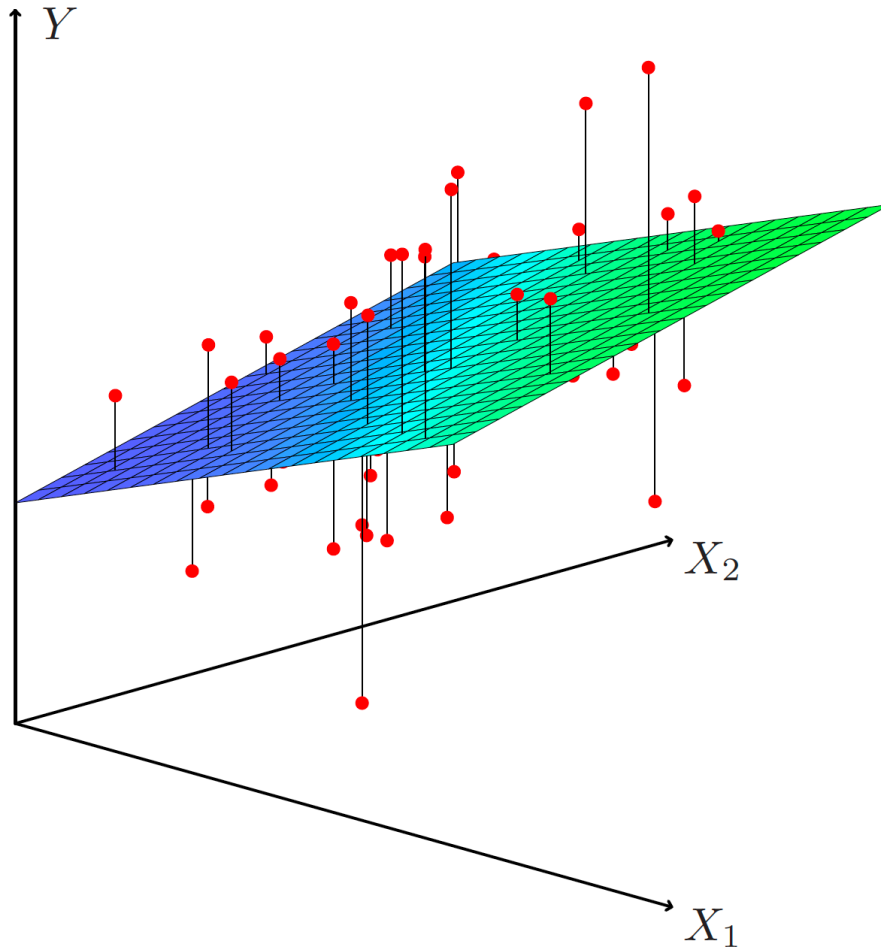
- Given a data set

$$D = \{(\mathbf{x}_1, y_1), (\mathbf{x}_2, y_2), \dots, (\mathbf{x}_m, y_m)\}$$

$$\mathbf{x}_i = (x_{i1}; x_{i2}; \dots; x_{id}) \quad y_i \in \mathbb{R}$$

- The objective of multivariate linear regression

$$\text{Find} \quad f(\mathbf{x}_i) = \mathbf{w}^T \mathbf{x}_i + b \quad \text{such that} \quad f(\mathbf{x}_i) \simeq y_i$$



# Multivariate Linear Regression

- Rewrite  $\mathbf{w}$  and  $b$  as  $\hat{\mathbf{w}} = (\mathbf{w}; b)$ , the data set is represented as

$$\mathbf{X} = \begin{pmatrix} x_{11} & x_{12} & \cdots & x_{1d} & 1 \\ x_{21} & x_{22} & \cdots & x_{2d} & 1 \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots & \vdots \\ x_{m1} & x_{m2} & \cdots & x_{md} & 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} \mathbf{x}_1^T & 1 \\ \mathbf{x}_2^T & 1 \\ \vdots & \vdots \\ \mathbf{x}_m^T & 1 \end{pmatrix}$$

$$\mathbf{y} = (y_1; y_2; \dots; y_m)$$

# Multivariate Linear Regression - Least Square Method

## □ Least square method

$$\hat{\mathbf{w}}^* = \arg \min_{\hat{\mathbf{w}}} (\mathbf{y} - \mathbf{X}\hat{\mathbf{w}})^T (\mathbf{y} - \mathbf{X}\hat{\mathbf{w}})$$

Let  $E_{\hat{\mathbf{w}}} = (\mathbf{y} - \mathbf{X}\hat{\mathbf{w}})^T (\mathbf{y} - \mathbf{X}\hat{\mathbf{w}})$  and find the derivative  $\hat{\mathbf{w}}$  with respect to

$$\frac{\partial E_{\hat{\mathbf{w}}}}{\partial \hat{\mathbf{w}}} = 2\mathbf{X}^T (\mathbf{X}\hat{\mathbf{w}} - \mathbf{y})$$

The closed-form solution of  $\hat{\mathbf{w}}$  can be obtained by making the equation equal to 0.



# Multivariate Linear Regression - Least Square Method

- If  $\mathbf{X}^T \mathbf{X}$  is a **full-rank matrix** or a positive definite matrix, then

$$\hat{\mathbf{w}}^* = (\mathbf{X}^T \mathbf{X})^{-1} \mathbf{X}^T \mathbf{y}$$

where  $(\mathbf{X}^T \mathbf{X})^{-1}$  is the **inverse** of  $\mathbf{X}^T \mathbf{X}$ , the learned multivariate linear regression model is

$$f(\hat{\mathbf{x}}_i) = \hat{\mathbf{x}}_i^T (\mathbf{X}^T \mathbf{X})^{-1} \mathbf{X}^T \mathbf{y}$$

- $\mathbf{X}^T \mathbf{X}$  is often not full-rank
- gradient descent (which is more broadly applicable)
  - pseudo-inverse

过程:

$$w^* = \arg \min_w (y - X\hat{w})^T (y - X\hat{w}) = \arg \min E\hat{w}$$

$$\frac{\partial E\hat{w}}{\partial \hat{w}} = \frac{(y^T - \hat{w}^T X^T)(y - X\hat{w})}{\partial w}$$

$$= \frac{y^T y - y^T X \hat{w} - \hat{w}^T X^T y + \hat{w}^T X^T X \hat{w}}{\partial w}$$

$$= -X^T y - X^T y + 2X^T X \hat{w}$$

$$= 2X^T (X\hat{w} - y)$$

$$= 2X^T X \hat{w} - 2X^T y = 0$$

$$\hat{w} = (X^T X)^{-1} X^T y$$

因此:  $f(\hat{x}_i) = \hat{w}^T \hat{x}_i = \hat{x}_i^T \hat{w} = \hat{x}_i^T (X^T X)^{-1} X^T y$

重要矩阵求导公式:

$$\frac{\partial AX}{\partial X} = A^T \quad \frac{\partial AX^T}{\partial X} = A$$

$$\frac{\partial X^T A X}{\partial X} = (A^T + A)X$$

# Learning as optimization

- The main idea

- Make two assumptions:

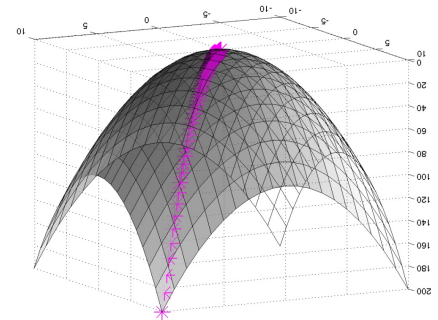
- the classifier is linear ✓
    - we want to find the classifier  $\theta$  that “fits the data best”

- Formalize as an optimization problem

- Pick a loss function  $J(\theta, \mathcal{D})$ , and find  $\operatorname{argmin}_{\theta} J(\theta)$
    - OR: Pick a “goodness” function, often  $\Pr(\mathcal{D}|\theta)$ , and find the  $\operatorname{argmax}_{\theta} f_{\mathcal{D}}(\theta)$

# Learning as optimization with gradient ascent

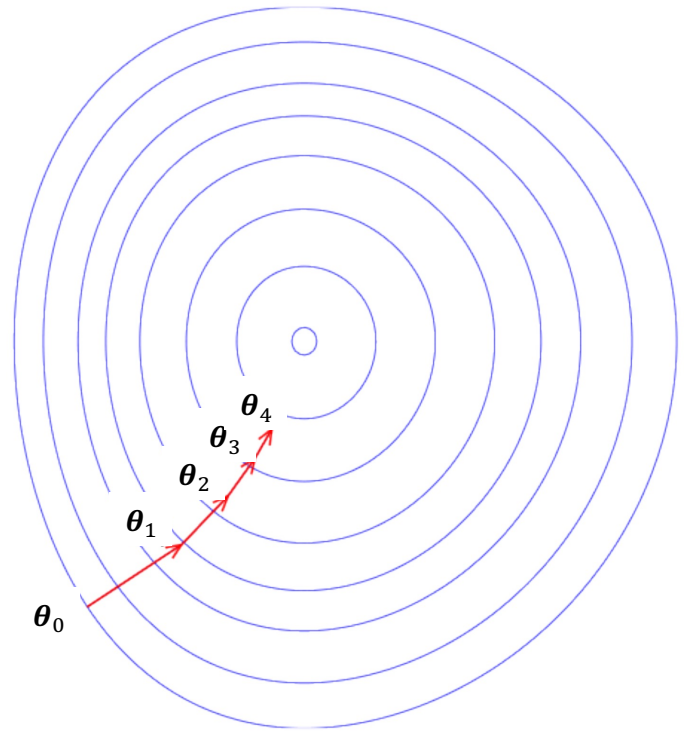
- **Goal:** Learn the parameter  $\theta$  of ...
- **Dataset:**  $\mathcal{D} = \{(\mathbf{x}_1, y_1) \dots, (\mathbf{x}_m, y_m)\}$
- Use your model to define
  - $\Pr(\mathcal{D}|\theta) = \dots$
- Set  $\theta$  to maximize Likelihood
  - Usually we use numeric methods to find the optimum
  - i.e., **gradient ascent**: repeatedly take a small step in the direction of the gradient (direction of fastest increase in the function).



# Gradient ascent

梯度下降的过程

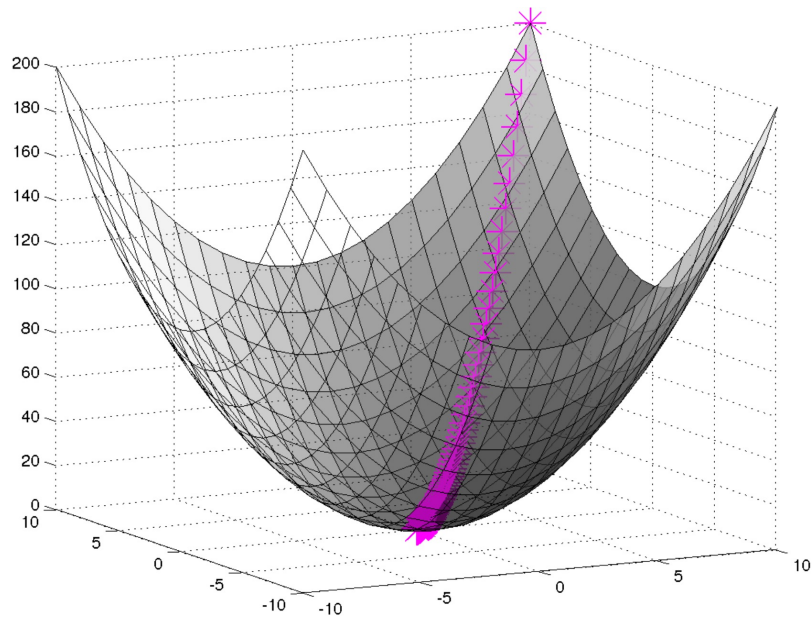
- To find  $\operatorname{argmax}_{\theta} f(\theta)$ :
  - Start with  $\theta_0$
  - For  $t = 1 \dots$ 
    - $\theta_{t+1} = \theta_t + \alpha f'(\theta_t)$
  - where  $\alpha$  is a **learning rate**.
    - The larger it is, the faster  $\theta$  changes.
    - The values of  $\alpha$  are typically small, e.g. 0.01 or 0.0001



Slide courtesy of William Cohen

# Gradient descent

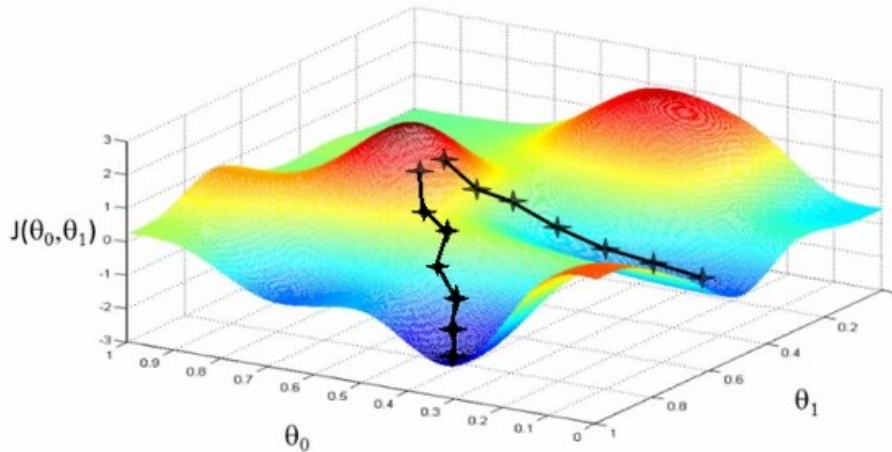
- Likelihood: ascent
- Loss: descent



Slide courtesy of William Cohen

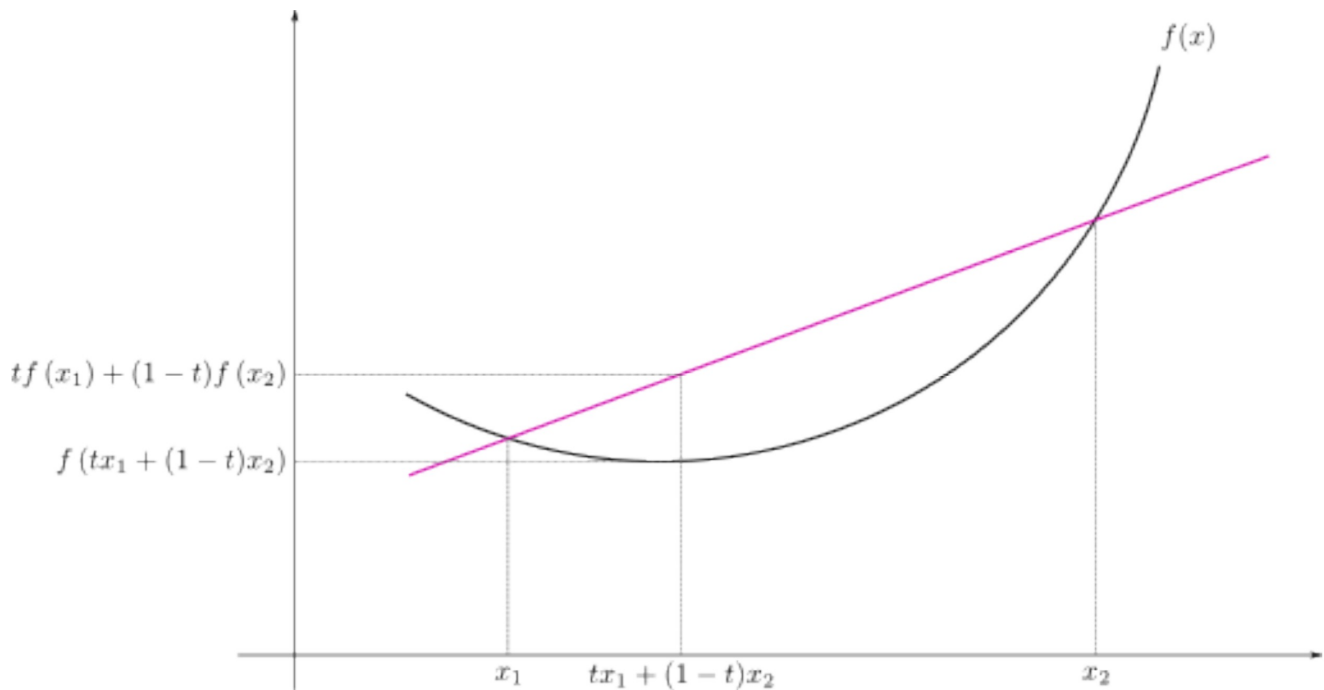
# Pros and cons of gradient descent

- Simple and often quite effective
- Often very scalable
- Only applies to smooth functions (differentiable)
- Might find a local minimum, rather than a global one



# Pros and cons of gradient descent

There is only one local optimum if the function is **convex**

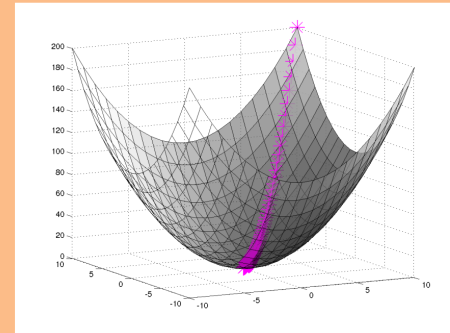




# Gradient Descent

## Algorithm 1 Gradient Descent

```
1: procedure GD( $\mathcal{D}$ ,  $\theta^{(0)}$ )
2:    $\theta \leftarrow \theta^{(0)}$ 
3:   while not converged do
4:      $\theta \leftarrow \theta - \alpha \nabla_{\theta} J(\theta)$ 
5:   return  $\theta$ 
```



In order to apply GD to Linear Regression all we need is the **gradient** of the objective function (i.e. vector of partial derivatives).

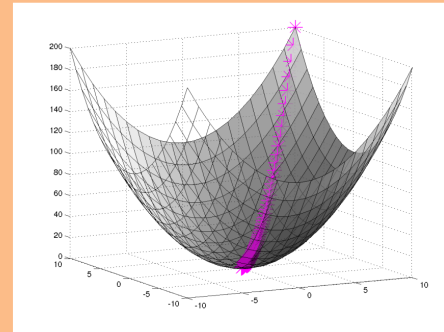
求导

$$\nabla_{\theta} J(\theta) = \begin{bmatrix} \frac{d}{d\theta_1} J(\theta) \\ \frac{d}{d\theta_2} J(\theta) \\ \vdots \\ \frac{d}{d\theta_N} J(\theta) \end{bmatrix}$$

# Gradient Descent

## Algorithm 1 Gradient Descent

```
1: procedure GD( $\mathcal{D}$ ,  $\theta^{(0)}$ )
2:    $\theta \leftarrow \theta^{(0)}$ 
3:   while not converged do
4:      $\theta \leftarrow \theta - \alpha \nabla_{\theta} J(\theta)$ 
5:   return  $\theta$ 
```



There are many possible ways to detect **convergence**. For example, we could check whether the L2 norm of the gradient is below some small tolerance.

$$\|\nabla_{\theta} J(\theta)\|_2 \leq \epsilon$$

↑ 1 停止条件  
↓ 2

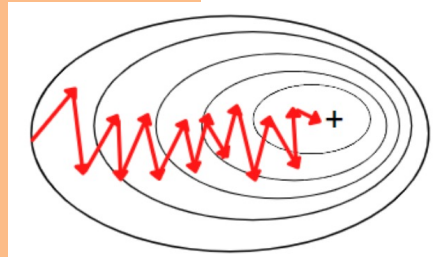
Alternatively we could check that the reduction in the objective function from one iteration to the next is small.

# Stochastic Gradient Descent (SGD)

随机梯度, 每次随机选择一小部分样本

## Algorithm 2 Stochastic Gradient Descent (SGD)

```
1: procedure SGD( $\mathcal{D}$ ,  $\theta^{(0)}$ )
2:    $\theta \leftarrow \theta^{(0)}$ 
3:   while not converged do
4:     for  $i \in \text{shuffle}(\{1, 2, \dots, N\})$  do
5:        $\theta \leftarrow \theta - \alpha \nabla_{\theta} J^{(i)}(\theta)$ 
6:   return  $\theta$ 
```



Applied to Linear Regression, SGD is called the **Least Mean Squares (LMS)** algorithm

We need a per-example objective:

$$\text{Let } J(\theta) = \sum_{i=1}^m J^{(i)}(\theta) \quad \text{where } J^{(i)}(\theta) = \frac{1}{2} (\theta^T \mathbf{x}^{(i)} - y^{(i)})^2.$$

# Partial Derivatives for Linear Reg.

$$\text{Let } J(\boldsymbol{\theta}) = \sum_{i=1}^m J^{(i)}(\boldsymbol{\theta}) \quad \text{where } J^{(i)}(\boldsymbol{\theta}) = \frac{1}{2}(\boldsymbol{\theta}^T \mathbf{x}^{(i)} - y^{(i)})^2.$$

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{d}{d\theta_k} J^{(i)}(\boldsymbol{\theta}) &= \frac{d}{d\theta_k} \frac{1}{2} (\boldsymbol{\theta}^T \mathbf{x}^{(i)} - y^{(i)})^2 \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \frac{d}{d\theta_k} (\boldsymbol{\theta}^T \mathbf{x}^{(i)} - y^{(i)})^2 \\ &= (\boldsymbol{\theta}^T \mathbf{x}^{(i)} - y^{(i)}) \frac{d}{d\theta_k} (\boldsymbol{\theta}^T \mathbf{x}^{(i)} - y^{(i)}) \\ &= (\boldsymbol{\theta}^T \mathbf{x}^{(i)} - y^{(i)}) \frac{d}{d\theta_k} \left( \sum_{k=1}^K \theta_k x_k^{(i)} - y^{(i)} \right) \\ &= (\boldsymbol{\theta}^T \mathbf{x}^{(i)} - y^{(i)}) x_k^{(i)} \end{aligned}$$

# Partial Derivatives for Linear Reg.

GD 可以看成 SGD 的求和

$$\text{Let } J(\boldsymbol{\theta}) = \sum_{i=1}^m J^{(i)}(\boldsymbol{\theta}) \quad \text{where } J^{(i)}(\boldsymbol{\theta}) = \frac{1}{2}(\boldsymbol{\theta}^T \mathbf{x}^{(i)} - y^{(i)})^2.$$

$$\frac{d}{d\theta_k} J^{(i)}(\boldsymbol{\theta}) = (\boldsymbol{\theta}^T \mathbf{x}^{(i)} - y^{(i)}) x_k^{(i)}$$

Used by SGD  
(aka. LMS)

$$\frac{d}{d\theta_k} J(\boldsymbol{\theta}) = \frac{d}{d\theta_k} \sum_{i=1}^N J^{(i)}(\boldsymbol{\theta})$$

$$= \sum_{i=1}^N (\boldsymbol{\theta}^T \mathbf{x}^{(i)} - y^{(i)}) x_k^{(i)}$$

Used by  
Gradient  
Descent

# Least Squares

**Learning:** Three approaches to solving  $\theta^* = \arg \min_{\theta} J(\theta)$

- ❑ **Approach 1:** Closed Form  
(set derivatives equal to zero and solve for parameters)
  - pros: one shot algorithm!
  - cons: does not scale to large datasets (matrix inverse is bottleneck)
- ❑ **Approach 2:** Gradient Descent  
(take larger – more certain – steps opposite the gradient)
  - pros: conceptually simple, guaranteed convergence
  - cons: batch, often slow to converge
- ❑ **Approach 3:** Stochastic Gradient Descent (SGD)  
(take many small steps opposite the gradient)
  - pros: memory efficient, fast convergence, less prone to local optima
  - cons: convergence in practice requires tuning and fancier variants

# Gradient Descent

- Why gradient descent, if we can find the optimum directly?
  - GD can be applied to a much broader set of models
  - GD can be easier to implement than direct solutions, especially with automatic differentiation software
  - For regression in high-dimensional spaces, GD is more efficient than
  - direct solution (matrix inversion is an  $O(D^3)$  algorithm).

# Probabilistic Interpretation of LMS

概率解释：最大似然推导出 LMS

- Let us assume that the target variable and the inputs are related by the equation:

$$y_i = \boldsymbol{\theta}^T \mathbf{x}_i + \epsilon_i$$

where  $\epsilon$  is an error term of unmodeled effects or random noise

- Now assume that  $\epsilon$  follows a Gaussian  $\mathcal{N}(0, \sigma^2)$ , then we have:

$$p(y_i | \mathbf{x}_i; \boldsymbol{\theta}) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi}\sigma} \exp\left(-\frac{(y_i - \boldsymbol{\theta}^T \mathbf{x}_i)^2}{2\sigma^2}\right)$$

- By independence assumption:

$$L(\boldsymbol{\theta}) = \prod_{i=1}^m p(y_i | \mathbf{x}_i; \boldsymbol{\theta}) = \left(\frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi}\sigma}\right)^m \exp\left(-\frac{\sum_{i=1}^m (y_i - \boldsymbol{\theta}^T \mathbf{x}_i)^2}{2\sigma^2}\right)$$



# Probabilistic Interpretation of LMS

- Hence the log-likelihood is:

$$l(\boldsymbol{\theta}) = m \log \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi}\sigma} - \frac{1}{2\sigma^2} \sum_{i=1}^m (y_i - \boldsymbol{\theta}^T \mathbf{x}_i)^2$$

- Do you recognize the last term?

Yes it is: 
$$J(\boldsymbol{\theta}) = \frac{1}{2} \sum_{i=1}^m (y_i - \boldsymbol{\theta}^T \mathbf{x}_i)^2$$

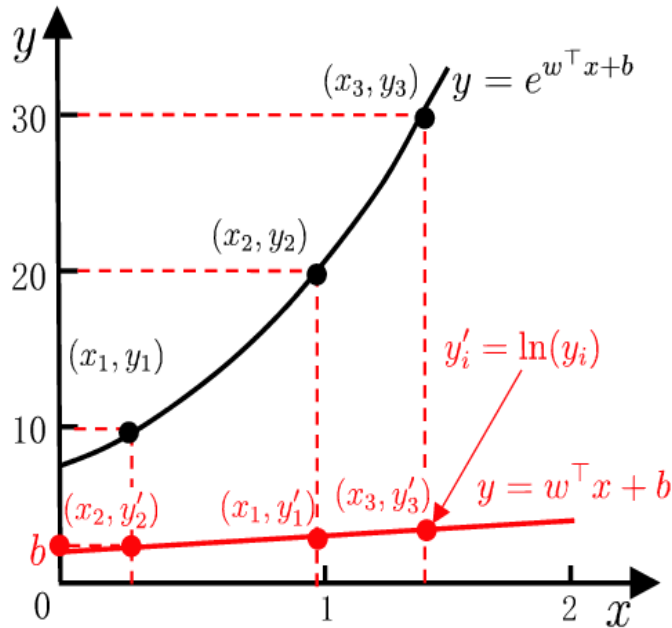
- Thus under independence assumption, LMS is equivalent to MLE of  $\boldsymbol{\theta}$  !

Although the model assumes a Gaussian distribution in the prediction (i.e. Gaussian noise function or error function), there is no such expectation for the inputs to the model ( $\mathbf{x}$ ).

# Log-Linear Regression

非线性变化来构建线性模型

- The logarithm of the output label can be used for approximation



$$\ln y = w^T x + b$$



$$y = w^T x + b$$